



FileLens

USER MANUAL

FileLens Complete Guide

Step-by-step instructions for finding any file, searching inside documents, OCR for images and scanned PDFs, Hindi typing, duplicate cleanup, and more.

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For FileLens v2.0 (Windows 10/11 64-bit)

Pages Complete end-user guide

2.0

PRO EDITION

Getting Started

Welcome to **FileLens** — a smart file search tool for Windows that helps you find any file on your computer in seconds. Unlike the built-in Windows search, FileLens searches not just file names but also the **text inside** your documents, PDFs, images, and even scanned files. This manual walks you through every feature in simple, step-by-step language.

What FileLens Can Do

- **Instant file search** — find files by name, content, or extension in milliseconds
- **OCR (image text extraction)** — read text from photos, screenshots, and scanned PDFs in English and Hindi
- **Hindi typing** — on-screen Devanagari keyboard + English-to-Hindi transliteration
- **Duplicate finder** — find and delete identical files to free up disk space
- **OCR Upload window** — upload any image, PDF, or Word document, extract its text, and search inside it
- **Sortable results** — click any column header to sort your search results
- **System tray + global hotkey** — summon FileLens from anywhere with Ctrl+Alt+S

Installing FileLens

- 1 Download the FileLens ZIP file from the official website:
narendragd999.github.io/FileLensWeb
- 2 Right-click the downloaded ZIP and choose **Extract All**. Pick a permanent folder like C:\FileLens (do not keep it in Downloads — the folder path must stay stable).
- 3 Open the extracted folder and double-click **FileLens.exe** to launch the app.
- 4 A welcome message appears telling you that your **7-day free trial** has started. All features are fully unlocked during the trial. Click OK.
- 5 The main FileLens window opens. You are ready to start searching.

TIP — WHERE TO INSTALL

Do not install FileLens in a folder that requires administrator permission (like C:\Program Files). Use your Desktop, Documents, or a custom folder like C:\FileLens. This avoids Windows permission prompts.

The Main Window Layout

When you launch FileLens, you see four main areas:

- **Toolbar (top)** — buttons for Index, Refresh, OCR, Duplicates, OCR Upload, Tools, Filters, Export, Save, Bookmarks, Help, Settings, Theme
- **Sidebar (left)** — navigation: Home, Bookmarks, Saved Searches, Duplicates, OCR Upload, Settings. Also shows file count and license status.
- **Search bar + results grid (center)** — type your search here; results appear in a sortable table below
- **Preview panel (right)** — shows a preview of the selected file

CHAPTER 2

Setting Up Your File Index

Before FileLens can search your files, it needs to build an **index** — a catalog of all files in the folders you choose. This is a one-time setup. After the first index, FileLens watches for new/changed files automatically.

Choosing Which Folders to Index

- 1 Click the **Settings** button in the sidebar (or press `Ctrl+,`).
- 2 Go to the **Index Locations** section.
- 3 Click **Add Folder** and pick the folders you want to search. Good choices: Documents, Desktop, Downloads, and any project folders.
- 4 Avoid indexing `C:\Windows` or `C:\Program Files` — they contain thousands of system files you will never search for.
- 5 Click **Save**.

Building the Index (First Time)

- 1 Click the ⚡ **Index** button in the toolbar.
- 2 A progress bar appears at the bottom showing how many files have been scanned.
- 3 Wait for indexing to finish. For 50,000 files this takes about 2–5 minutes. Large drives with hundreds of thousands of files may take 15–30 minutes.
- 4 When done, the sidebar shows " **X files indexed**".

NOTE — OCR RUNS SEPARATELY

During the first index, FileLens reads file names and text content (from PDFs, Word, Excel, etc.) but does **not** run OCR on images yet. OCR runs as a second pass after the index finishes — see Chapter 4 for details.

Auto-Indexing (Set and Forget)

FileLens can automatically re-index your folders on a schedule. In Settings, set **Scheduled Index Time** to a time when your computer is usually on (default is 2:00 AM). FileLens will refresh the index daily without you having to remember.

Additionally, FileLens watches your indexed folders in real time. When you save a new file, edit one, or delete one, the index updates within seconds — no manual refresh needed.

CHAPTER 3

Searching for Files

This is the core feature of FileLens. Type a word, and FileLens instantly shows every file whose name or content contains that word.

Basic Search

- 1 Click the search bar at the top center (or press `Ctrl+F`).
- 2 Type what you are looking for — for example, `invoice` or `report 2026`.
- 3 Press **Enter** (or wait if live search is enabled — results appear as you type).
- 4 Results appear in the grid below, sorted by relevance (best matches first).
- 5 Double-click any result to open the file in its default app.

Search Modes

FileLens supports 8 search modes. Click the mode dropdown next to the search bar to switch:

- **Partial** (default) — matches any part of a word. Typing `inv` finds "invoice", "inventory", "invest".
- **Exact** — matches the exact phrase only. Typing `invoice 2026` finds files containing that exact phrase.
- **Whole Word** — matches complete words only. Typing `cat` finds "cat" but not "category".
- **Wildcard** — use `*` and `?`. Example: `report*.pdf` finds all PDFs starting with "report".
- **Regex** — for advanced users. Use regular expressions like `^invoice_\d{4}`.
- **Fuzzy** — finds close matches even with typos. Typing `invocie` still finds "invoice".
- **Boolean** — combine terms with AND, OR, NOT. Example: `invoice AND 2026 NOT draft`.
- **Similar** — finds files with similar-sounding content.

Sorting Search Results

Your search results appear in a table with these columns: **Name, Folder, Type, Size, Modified, Page, Matches, Score**. You can sort by any column:

- 1 Click any column header (e.g. **Size**) — results sort by size, smallest first. An ▲ **arrow** appears next to the header.
- 2 Click the same header again — it sorts descending (largest first). The arrow changes to ▼.
- 3 Click a different column — it switches to sort by that column, ascending.
- 4 Your chosen sort is remembered — when you run a new search, results stay sorted by your selected column.

TIP — SORT BY SCORE FOR BEST MATCHES

By default, results are sorted by **Score** (relevance) descending — the best matches appear first. If you sort by another column and want to go back to relevance order, click the **Score** header twice (once for ascending, once for descending).

Searching Inside File Content

FileLens searches the text *inside* your documents, not just the file name. This works for:

- PDF files (both text PDFs and scanned PDFs after OCR)
- Microsoft Word (.docx, .doc)
- Microsoft Excel (.xlsx)
- Microsoft PowerPoint (.pptx)
- Text files (.txt, .md, .csv)
- HTML and XML files
- Programming source code (.py, .js, .java, etc.)
- Images (after OCR — see Chapter 4)

Example: if you search for `contract` and a Word document somewhere in your indexed folders contains the word "contract" in its body text, that document appears in the results — even if the file name is `Legal_Draft_v3.docx`.

Extension-Aware Search

If you type a file extension in your search (like `report.pdf` or `32.docx`), FileLens automatically filters results to only that file type. This prevents typing `32.pdf` from showing every PDF on your computer — it shows only PDFs with "32" in the name or content.

CHAPTER 4

OCR — Reading Text from Images

OCR (Optical Character Recognition) lets FileLens read text from images and scanned documents. After OCR runs, you can search for words inside images just like you search inside text documents.

What OCR Can Read

- Photos of documents (JPG, PNG, BMP, TIFF, WebP)
- Screenshots
- Scanned PDF files (PDFs that are just images of pages, no text layer)
- Scanned Word documents (.docx with embedded images)
- Text in **English** and **Hindi (Devanagari)**

Running OCR on Your Indexed Images

- 1 After your first index finishes (see Chapter 2), click the  **OCR** button in the toolbar.
- 2 A progress bar shows how many images have been processed.
- 3 OCR runs in the background — you can keep using FileLens while it works.
- 4 When done, the sidebar shows " **OCR: X done • Y pending**".
- 5 Now you can search for words that appear inside your images.

IMPORTANT — HINDI OCR REQUIRES THE HINDI LANGUAGE PACK

FileLens bundles English OCR by default. To read Hindi (Devanagari) text from images, make sure the **hin** language pack is installed. In Settings → OCR, check that the language is set to `eng+hin` (the default). The status indicator in the OCR Upload window shows which languages Tesseract has available.

Understanding OCR Quality

OCR accuracy depends on image quality. For best results:

- Use high-resolution images (at least 150 DPI for documents)
- Ensure good contrast — black text on white background works best
- Avoid skewed/rotated images — straighten them before OCR
- Handwritten text cannot be OCR'd reliably — only printed text works well

CHAPTER 5

OCR Upload Window — Upload, Extract, and Search

The **OCR Upload window** is a separate feature that lets you upload any file (even files not in your indexed folders), OCR them, and search inside the extracted text — all without adding them to your main index.

Opening the OCR Upload Window

Three ways to open it:

- Click the  **OCR Upload** button in the toolbar
- Click  **OCR Upload** in the sidebar
- Press `Ctrl+Shift+U` from anywhere in FileLens

Uploading Files

The OCR Upload window accepts these file types:

- **Images:** PNG, JPG, JPEG, BMP, GIF, TIFF, WebP, JP2, PNM
- **PDFs:** both text PDFs and scanned (image-only) PDFs
- **Word documents:** .docx and .doc (scanned Word files are auto-detected — embedded images are extracted and OCR'd)

To upload, do any of the following:

- 1 Click **+ Add Files...** (or press Ctrl+O) and select one or more files.
- 2 Click  **Add Folder...** (or press Ctrl+Shift+O) to add all supported files from a folder.
- 3 **Drag and drop** files or folders directly onto the window.

Running OCR

- 1 Add your files using any method above. They appear in the left list with status  **Pending**.
- 2 Click  **OCR All Pending** (or press Ctrl+R) to OCR every pending file.
- 3 Alternatively, select specific files and click  **OCR Selected** to OCR only those.
- 4 OCR runs in a background thread — the window stays responsive. Each file's status updates from  to  (processing) to  (done) or  (failed).
- 5 When a file finishes, click it to see its OCR'd text in the right panel.

Choosing the OCR Language

The toolbar has a  **Lang:** dropdown showing the active OCR language. The default is `eng+hin` (English + Hindi). To switch:

- 1 Click the dropdown.
- 2 Pick a language — presets include `eng+hin`, `eng`, `hin`, and `eng+hin+osd`.
- 3 If a language is not installed, it shows "(missing)" next to it.
- 4 After switching, re-run OCR on any pending/failed files to apply the new language.

Searching Inside OCR'd Text

Once a file is OCR'd, you can search inside its text:

- 1 Select the file in the left list.
- 2 Type your search term in the **search box** at the top of the right panel.
- 3 All matches are highlighted in **yellow**; the current match is highlighted in **orange**.
- 4 The match counter shows "**Match X of Y**" (e.g. "Match 3 of 12").

Navigating Between Matches

Use these controls to jump between matches:

KEY	ACTION
Enter	Next match
Shift+Enter	Previous match
F3	Next match
Shift+F3	Previous match
Ctrl+G	Next match
Ctrl+Shift+G	Previous match
Esc	Clear search

You can also click the ◀ **Prev** and **Next** ▶ buttons. Navigation wraps around — after the last match, it goes back to the first.

Search Options

Three checkboxes next to the search box let you control matching:

- **Aa** — case-sensitive matching (on = "Cat" and "cat" are different)
- **W** — whole-word matching only
- **.*** — treat the search term as a regular expression

Transliteration (English to Hindi)

If you want to search for a Hindi word but only know how to type it in English, use the ✨ Transliterate button:

- 1 Type the word in English in the search box — e.g. ram singh sisodiya
- 2 Click ✨ **Transliterate** (or press Ctrl+Shift+H).
- 3 The text is converted to Devanagari — राम सिंह सिसोदिया — using Google's online transliteration service (with an offline dictionary fallback).
- 4 The search re-runs automatically with the Hindi text, and all matches in the OCR'd content are highlighted.

EXAMPLE

ram singh sisodiya → राम सिंह सिसोदिया

Exporting OCR Text

To save the OCR'd text of the currently selected file:

- 1 Select the file in the left list.
- 2 Click 📄 **Export Current Text...** (or press Ctrl+E).
- 3 Choose where to save the .txt file.

CHAPTER 6

Hindi Typing & Transliteration

FileLens has built-in Hindi (Devanagari) text entry so you can search for Hindi words without installing a separate Hindi keyboard on Windows.

On-Screen Hindi Keyboard

- 1 Click the  button next to the main search bar.
- 2 A popup keyboard appears with all Devanagari characters arranged in 7 rows: vowels, consonants, matras, digits, and punctuation.
- 3 Click any character to insert it into the search bar.
- 4 Use the  button for backspace.
- 5 Click  again to close the keyboard.

English to Hindi Transliteration

If you can type Hindi words in English (Roman script) but want them converted to Devanagari, use transliteration:

- 1 Type the word in English in the main search bar — e.g. `bharat sarkar`
- 2 Press `Ctrl+Shift+H` (or click the  **Transliterate** button inside the Hindi keyboard popup).
- 3 The text is converted to Devanagari: भारत सरकार
- 4 Press Enter to search. FileLens finds files containing that Hindi text.

MORE EXAMPLES

`bharat` → भारत `sarkar` → सरकार `aadhar` → आधार

TIP — ONLINE VS OFFLINE

Transliteration uses Google Input Tools (online) for best quality. If you have no internet, it falls back to a built-in offline dictionary that covers 80+ common Hindi words. For uncommon words, the offline dictionary may not have a mapping — in that case, use the on-screen keyboard instead.

CHAPTER 7

Duplicate File Finder

Over time, we all accumulate duplicate files — the same photo saved in three folders, the same document downloaded twice. FileLens finds these duplicates and lets you delete them safely to reclaim disk space.

Finding Duplicates

- 1 Click the  **Duplicates** button in the toolbar (or press `Ctrl+D`, or click  **Duplicates** in the sidebar).
- 2 The Duplicate Finder dialog opens.
- 3 Choose the folders to scan for duplicates (defaults to your indexed folders).
- 4 Click **Scan**.
- 5 FileLens compares files by their **SHA-256 checksum** — this means two files are considered duplicates only if their contents are byte-for-byte identical, even if the names differ.
- 6 Results appear grouped: each group shows all copies of the same file.

Deleting Duplicates Safely

- 1 In each duplicate group, FileLens marks the "original" (usually the oldest copy) with a green checkmark.
- 2 The other copies are marked for deletion (red X).
- 3 Review the list — you can manually keep or delete any file by toggling its checkbox.
- 4 Click **Delete Selected**.
- 5 Deleted files go to the **Windows Recycle Bin** — not permanently deleted. You can recover them from the Recycle Bin if you make a mistake.

CAUTION — REVIEW BEFORE DELETING

Always review the duplicate list before clicking Delete. Sometimes files have the same content but different purposes (e.g. a template that was intentionally copied to multiple project folders). The Recycle Bin gives you a safety net, but it is still better to review.

Tools, Filters & Export

File System Tools

Click the  **Tools** button to open a dialog with these utilities:

Empty Folder Finder

Scans your indexed folders and lists all empty subfolders. You can delete them in bulk to tidy up your drive.

Large File Finder

Lists the biggest files on your indexed drives. Useful for finding that 5 GB video you forgot about.

Disk Usage

Shows a breakdown of how much space each folder consumes, so you can see where your disk space went.

Health Check

Verifies that your index is healthy — checks database integrity, OCR queue status, and recommends fixes if something looks wrong.

Filters

Click  **Filters** (or press `Ctrl+Shift+F`) to narrow your search results:

- **By location** — only show files in specific folders
- **By file type** — only PDFs, only images, only documents, etc.
- **By extension** — only .docx, only .jpg, etc.
- **By size** — only files larger than / smaller than X MB
- **By date** — only files modified after / before a date
- **By owner** — only files owned by a specific Windows user
- **Quick date filters** — buttons for Today, This Week, This Month, This Year (above the results grid)

Exporting Search Results

- 1 Run a search to get results in the grid.
- 2 Click  **Export** (or press `Ctrl+E`).
- 3 Choose the export format: **CSV** (for Excel), **JSON** (for developers), or **HTML** (for sharing).
- 4 Pick where to save the file.
- 5 The exported file contains the file name, path, size, modified date, match count, and score for every result.

Bookmarks & Saved Searches

-  **Bookmarks** — right-click any search result and choose "Bookmark this file". Bookmarked files appear in the sidebar under Bookmarks for quick access.
-  **Saved Searches** — after running a search, click  **Save** to save the query + filters. Give it a name like "Invoices 2026". Later, click the saved search in the sidebar to re-run it instantly.

CHAPTER 9

Settings & Customization

Click  **Settings** (or press `Ctrl+,`) to customize FileLens. Changes take effect immediately unless noted.

General

- **Theme** — Dark (default) or Light. Toggle instantly with `Ctrl+T`.
- **Accent color** — pick a custom highlight color for buttons and links.
- **Start minimized** — launch FileLens hidden in the system tray.
- **Check for updates** — automatically check for new versions on startup.

Indexing

- **Index locations** — add or remove folders from the index.
- **Excluded folders** — folders to skip (e.g. `C:\Windows`, `node_modules`).
- **Excluded extensions** — file types to skip (e.g. `.tmp`, `.dll`).
- **Max file size** — skip files larger than this (default 1 GB).
- **Index hidden/system files** — off by default for safety.
- **Worker threads** — auto-tuned based on your CPU. More threads = faster indexing.

OCR

- **Enabled** — turn OCR on/off globally.
- **Language** — default eng+hin. Change to eng for English-only (faster) or add more languages.
- **Tesseract path** — if you installed Tesseract elsewhere, specify the path here.
- **Max image size** — skip images larger than this (default 5 MB).
- **Max dimension** — downscale large images before OCR (default 2000 px).
- **Auto-run after index** — automatically start OCR when indexing finishes.

Search

- **Default mode** — Partial, Exact, Whole Word, etc.
- **Case sensitive** — on/off by default.
- **Live search** — search as you type (with a debounce to avoid lag).
- **Max results** — cap on how many results to show (default 10,000).
- **Highlight matches** — highlight the search term in preview snippets.

Background & Shortcuts

- **Run in background** — when you close the window, FileLens keeps running in the system tray instead of quitting.
- **Global summon hotkey** — default `Ctrl+Alt+S`. Brings FileLens to the foreground from any app.
- **Hindi transliterate shortcut** — default `Ctrl+Shift+H`.

CHAPTER 10

System Tray & Global Hotkeys

Running in the Background

When **Run in background** is enabled (default), clicking the window's X button does not quit FileLens — it minimizes to the system tray (the small icons next to your clock). This lets FileLens keep watching your folders for changes and stay ready for instant search.

To bring the window back:

- Single-click the FileLens icon  in the system tray, **or**
- Press `Ctrl+Alt+S` from anywhere (even if you are in another app), **or**
- Right-click the tray icon and choose **Show**.

To actually quit FileLens: right-click the tray icon and choose **Quit** (or press `Ctrl+Q` while the window is visible).

Tray Icon Menu

Right-click the tray icon for quick access to:

- **Show** — bring FileLens to the front
- **Index** — start a re-index
- **OCR** — start an OCR pass
- **Theme** — toggle dark/light
- **Quit** — fully exit FileLens

Complete Keyboard Shortcut Reference

SHORTCUT	ACTION
Ctrl+F	Focus the search bar
Ctrl+D	Open Duplicate Finder
Ctrl+Shift+U	Open OCR Upload window
Ctrl+Shift+F	Open Filters dialog
Ctrl+Shift+H	Transliterate search text (English to Hindi)
Ctrl+E	Export search results / OCR text
Ctrl+T	Toggle dark/light theme
Ctrl+,	Open Settings
Ctrl+Q	Quit FileLens
Ctrl+R	OCR all pending files (in OCR Upload window)
Ctrl+O	Add files (in OCR Upload window)
F5	Refresh results
F3 / Shift+F3	Next / previous match (in OCR Upload window)
Ctrl+G / Ctrl+Shift+G	Next / previous match (in OCR Upload window)
Esc	Clear search / focus search bar
Ctrl+Alt+S	Global hotkey — summon FileLens from anywhere

License & Activation

7-Day Free Trial

When you first install FileLens, you get a **7-day free trial** with all features fully unlocked. No credit card needed — just download and start using. The sidebar shows a badge with how many days are left:

- **Blue badge** — more than 3 days left
- **Amber badge** — 1–3 days left (warning)
- **Red badge** — trial expired

Purchasing a License

- 1 Go to the FileLens website: narendragd999.github.io/FileLensWeb
- 2 Click **Purchase** and pay ₹199 via UPI or card.
- 3 Open FileLens. The sidebar badge shows your **Machine ID** — a unique code that identifies your computer. Click the badge to see it.
- 4 Copy your Machine ID and email it to filelenspro@gmail.com along with your payment receipt.
- 5 You will receive your license key by email (usually within a few hours).

Activating Your License

- 1 Click the trial badge in the sidebar (or go to Settings → License).
- 2 The License dialog shows your Machine ID and a field for the license key.
- 3 Paste the license key you received by email.
- 4 Click **Activate**. FileLens contacts the activation server and verifies the key.
- 5 If the key is valid, the badge changes to  **Licensed** and FileLens is permanently unlocked on this computer.

NOTE — ONE KEY PER MACHINE

Each license key is bound to one computer (identified by the Machine ID). If you reinstall Windows on the same hardware, the Machine ID stays the same — your key keeps working. If you buy a new computer, contact support to release the binding and re-issue the key for the new machine.

Offline Use

After activation, FileLens works fully offline. You only need internet the first time you activate a key. Subsequent launches check locally — no internet required. If you are offline for more than 7 days (168 hours), FileLens will ask you to connect briefly to re-verify, then continue working offline.

CHAPTER 12

Troubleshooting

FileLens Does Not Start

- Make sure you extracted the ZIP completely — do not run FileLens.exe from inside the ZIP file.
- Right-click FileLens.exe and choose **Run as administrator** (only needed if your user account lacks read access to indexed folders).
- Check Windows Defender / antivirus — it may have quarantined the EXE. Add an exception for the FileLens folder.
- If you see "VCRUNTIME140.dll missing", install the Microsoft Visual C++ Redistributable (x64) from Microsoft's website.

Search Returns No Results

- Make sure you have indexed folders — check the sidebar says "X files indexed" (not zero).
- Click ⚡ **Index** to rebuild the index if it is empty.
- Try a simpler search — if `report 2026 Q4 final` finds nothing, try just `report`.
- Check the search mode — if you are in "Exact" mode, switch to "Partial".
- Clear filters (Filters dialog → Reset).

OCR Produces Garbled Text

- Check the language dropdown — if you are OCR'ing Hindi text but the language is set to eng only, switch to eng+hin and re-run OCR.
- Improve image quality — higher resolution, better lighting, less skew.
- For scanned PDFs, ensure the PDF is not password-protected.
- Handwritten text cannot be OCR'd — only printed/typed text works.
- Very small text (under 8pt) or very low-contrast text may not be recognized.

OCR Is Slow

- OCR is CPU-intensive — a single high-resolution image can take 5–15 seconds.
- Increase the number of OCR workers (Settings → OCR → Concurrent workers).
- Reduce the max image dimension (Settings → OCR → Max dimension) — this downscales images before OCR, trading accuracy for speed.
- For bulk OCR of thousands of images, run it overnight.

Global Hotkey (Ctrl+Alt+S) Does Not Work

- Another app may have grabbed the same hotkey. Change it in Settings → Background & Shortcuts.
- If you are using Remote Desktop / a virtual machine, the hotkey may be intercepted by the host OS.

FileLens Uses Too Much Memory

- Reduce the cache size (Settings → Performance → Cache size MB).
- Index fewer folders, or exclude very large folders with many small files.
- Restart FileLens periodically — the cache is rebuilt on launch.

Getting Support

If none of the above solves your problem:

- Email **filelenspro@gmail.com** with a description of the issue and a screenshot.
- Include the log file — find it at %APPDATA%\FileLens\logs\filelens.log (paste this path into File Explorer's address bar).
- Include your Machine ID (from Settings → License) so we can look up your account.



FileLens

Smart file search for Windows. Find any file, any word, in any language — instantly.

Website: narendragd999.github.io/FileLensWeb

Support: filelenspro@gmail.com

Version: 2.0 Pro Edition